

Watch out for an overinflated human ego

The first person we need to **assess** for ego isn't someone else — it's ourselves. But before identifying signs of an overinflated ego, let's understand what ego truly means. In the Bhagavad Gita, **verse 7.4**, Krishna describes eight components of His nature: "Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence, and ego."

The Sanskrit word used for ego is ahankara, meaning "I am the doer." **This sense** of being the doer **is** natural when performing our duties. However, it becomes **problematic** when one starts to believe that they alone are responsible for success.

In reality, the Gita (18.14) **states** that there are five factors behind every action: the place of action, the doer, the instruments used, the various efforts, and **divine providence**. So how does ahankara relate to the commonly used term "ego"? In modern language, ego often refers to **self-esteem** or self-importance.

Though not identical in meaning, we'll use the term "ego" here for **convenience**. What are the signs of an overinflated ego? The most obvious is a lack of **humility**. **A person** with a large ego constantly **seeks** attention, **craves** importance, and often justifies their actions — even when wrong. They rarely accept feedback or correction, thinking they are better than others. This mindset **halts** growth. While each of us is unique, we are not superior to others. Personally, I don't want to be such a person. I've realised the dangers of an overinflated ego, it **isolates** us, **limits** our ability to form genuine connections, and blinds us to **wise counsel**. **Egoists** often ignore **sound** advice and act without considering different perspectives.

This makes them **prone to** mistakes. **In contrast**, a humble person recognises their limitations, values **input** from others, and remains **grounded**. Humility enhances decision-making and **fosters collaboration**. So how can we **overcome** this common weakness? Most of us, even if not **outright egoistic**, carry the **subtle** belief that we are solely responsible for our successes. It's not easy to limit ourselves to just our part and genuinely **acknowledge** the contributions of others — including God.

A devotee sees all five elements of success, including divine **grace**. Circumstances often **align** through no effort of our own. **For instance**, if rain **holds off** during an outdoor wedding or a skilled priest becomes available during the busy season — are these not signs of God's favour?

Even our physical **ability** to perform duties, such as a father recovering in time for his daughter's wedding, **is** a blessing. **Recognising** these as God's arrangements **helps curb** ego. To **keep ego in check**, the first and most essential quality is humility. Second, we must avoid comparing ourselves to others. What's the point?

With over eight billion people on the planet, someone will always be more talented or successful. Instead, train yourself to sincerely appreciate others. Lord Krishna Himself praised Arjuna repeatedly

to encourage him to follow the path of **righteousness**. **Learning** to see the good in others **softens** the ego.

It also helps to seek guidance — either from a genuine spiritual teacher or a wise friend. Personally, I've had a **long-standing** struggle with my own ego. **Becoming** aware of its harm **was** the first step, but changing was much harder. Our identity is often **intertwined** with our ego, and **letting go** can feel like losing ourselves.

Still, I **persevered**. I prayed sincerely for help and received support through divine **intuition** and a spiritual friend, who reminded me, "Humility brings God closer. When we feel superior, God **distances** Himself."

That truth struck me deeply. I need God's presence in every part of my life. Prayer has been a powerful tool in reducing my ego. One cannot be both truly devoted and **arrogantly self-centred**.

Before closing, let's consider: how should we **deal with** egoistic individuals? After all, we **encounter** them often. The Gita advises in verse 3.26 that the wise should not disturb the minds of the **ignorant**, but rather inspire by example.

Don't try to correct them forcefully. Instead, remain calm, lead with conduct, and focus on your own growth. We are not responsible for fixing others — we're responsible for ourselves. **[Practice Exercis.]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Watch out** (phrasal verb) – be careful, beware, pay attention, stay alert, take heed सावधान रहना
2. **Overinflated** (adjective) – exaggerated, bloated, puffed-up, excessive, overblown अत्यधिक बढ़ा-चढ़ा
3. **Assess** (verb) – evaluate, judge, examine, appraise, analyze मूल्यांकन करना
4. **Verse** (noun) – shloka, line, passage, scripture, couplet श्लोक / पद्यांश
5. **Problematic** (adjective) – troublesome, challenging, difficult, complicated, uncertain समस्याग्रस्त
6. **State** (verb) – declare, express, say, announce, articulate कहना / बताना
7. **Divine** (adjective) – godly, heavenly, spiritual, sacred, celestial दैवीय
8. **Providence** (noun) – fate, divine will, guidance, destiny, divine intervention ईश्वरीय कृपा / व्यवस्था
9. **Self-esteem** (noun) – self-worth, self-respect, confidence, dignity, self-regard आत्म-सम्मान
10. **Convenience** (noun) – ease, comfort, suitability, simplicity, accessibility सुविधा
11. **Humility** (noun) – modesty, humbleness, meekness, unpretentiousness, submission विनम्रता
12. **Seek** (verb) – look for, pursue, strive for, search, aim for खोजना / प्रयास करना
13. **Crave** (verb) – desire, long for, yearn, need, want तीव्र इच्छा करना
14. **Halt** (verb) – stop, pause, cease, discontinue, arrest रोकना
15. **Isolate** (verb) – separate, detach, alienate, disconnect, seclude अलग करना / अकेला करना
16. **Limit** (verb) – restrict, confine, curb, control, restrain सीमित करना
17. **Wise** (adjective) – knowledgeable, insightful, prudent, intelligent, sensible समझदार
18. **Counsel** (noun) – advice, guidance, suggestion, recommendation, direction सलाह
19. **Sound** (adjective) – solid, reliable, strong, valid, rational ठोस / सही
20. **Prone** (to) (adjective) – susceptible, inclined, likely, vulnerable, disposed प्रवृत्त / संवेदनशील
21. **In contrast** (phrase) – on the other hand, conversely, however, in opposition इसके विपरीत
22. **Input** (verb) – to take suggestion/ idea सुझाव लेना

23. **Ground** (verb) – root, stabilize, base, center, anchor आधारित करना / स्थिर करना
24. **Foster** (verb) – encourage, promote, nurture, support, cultivate बढ़ावा देना
25. **Collaboration** (noun) – cooperation, partnership, teamwork, alliance, coordination सहयोग
26. **Overcome** (verb) – defeat, conquer, prevail over, surpass, rise above काबू पाना
27. **Outright** (adjective) – complete, absolute, direct, total, unequivocal पूर्ण / स्पष्ट
28. **Egoistic** (adjective) – self-centered, egotistical, arrogant, boastful, vain आत्मकेंद्रित
29. **Subtle** (adjective) – slight, delicate, faint, understated, nuanced सूक्ष्म
30. **Acknowledge** (verb) – accept, admit, recognize, concede, appreciate स्वीकार करना
31. **Grace** (noun) – blessing, favor, kindness, mercy, benevolence कृपा / आशीर्वाद
32. **Align** (verb) – match, coordinate, adjust, synchronize, bring into line समन्वय करना
33. **For instance** (phrase) – for example, such as, like, namely, to illustrate उदाहरण के लिए
34. **Hold off** (phrasal verb) – delay, postpone, refrain, withhold, stay रोकना / टालना
35. **Curb** (verb) – control, restrain, suppress, limit, check रोक लगाना
36. **Keep in check** (phrase) – control, regulate, restrain, manage, monitor नियंत्रण में रखना
37. **Righteousness** (noun) – virtue, morality, goodness, integrity, dharma धर्मनिष्ठा / धार्मिकता
38. **Long-standing** (adjective) – enduring, persistent, time-tested, deep-rooted, old पुराना / दीर्घकालीन
39. **Intertwine** (verb) – interconnect, link, interweave, entangle, mesh जुड़ना / आपस में मिल जाना
40. **Letting go** (noun) – release, surrender, detachment, renunciation, giving up त्याग / छोड़ना
41. **Persevere** (verb) – persist, endure, continue, stay strong, push through डटे रहना
42. **Intuition** (noun) – inner sense, instinct, gut feeling, insight, perception अंतर्ज्ञान
43. **Distance** (verb) – detach, separate, alienate, isolate, remove दूर करना
44. **Arrogantly** (adverb) – proudly, haughtily, boastfully, conceitedly, smugly घमंड से
45. **Self-centred** (adjective) – egocentric, selfish, inward-looking, narcissistic, self-absorbed आत्मकेंद्रित

46. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – handle, manage, address, tackle, cope with निपटना

47. **Encounter** (verb) – face, come across, experience, meet, confront सामना करना

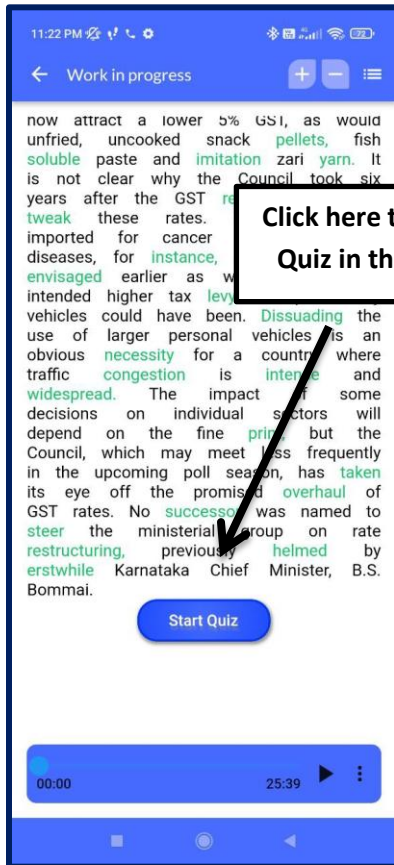
48. **The ignorant** (noun) – unknowing people, uninformed, uneducated, unaware, oblivious अज्ञानी लोग

@mocks_wallah

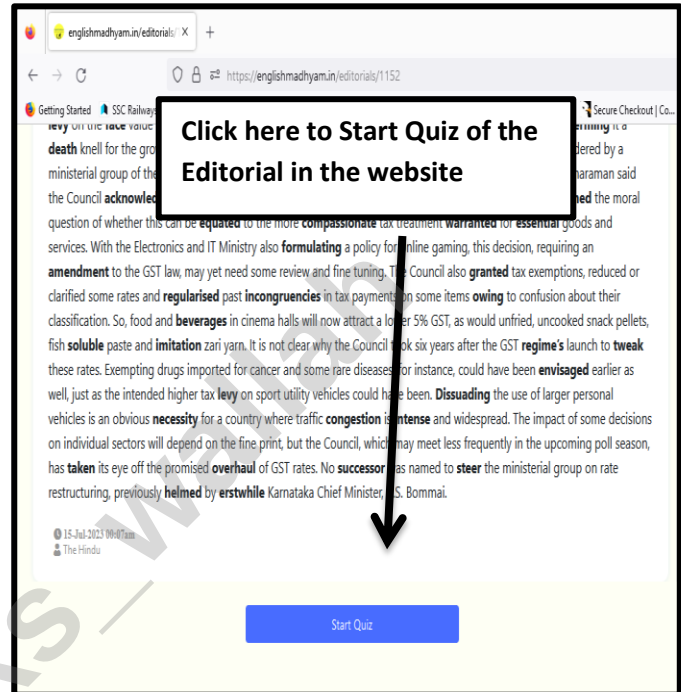
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Self-assessment of ego** is vital; before judging others, one must first examine their own sense of ego.
2. The **Bhagavad Gita (7.4)** defines ego as "**ahankara**", meaning "I am the doer," which is natural but dangerous when exaggerated.
3. According to **Gita (18.14)**, success is shaped by **five factors**: the place, the doer, instruments, efforts, and divine providence.
4. In modern usage, "**ego**" often refers to **self-importance or inflated self-esteem**, which can hinder personal growth.
5. Key **signs of an overinflated ego** include lack of humility, constant need for validation, rejection of criticism, and feeling superior.
6. Such a mindset leads to **isolation, poor decision-making**, and disconnection from genuine relationships and sound advice.
7. **Humility** is portrayed as a vital antidote to ego, enabling people to accept feedback, collaborate, and make wiser decisions.
8. The belief that **success is solely self-earned** is misleading; success often involves contributions from others and divine factors.
9. The **examples of divine providence**, such as favorable weather or good timing, emphasize that not all outcomes are self-driven.
10. Recognizing the role of **God or divine grace** helps in cultivating humility and reducing ego.
11. Avoiding **comparison with others** is another way to combat ego; admiration of others' talents softens the tendency for pride.
12. Even **Lord Krishna praised Arjuna** to guide him towards righteousness — highlighting the importance of encouraging others positively.
13. Seeking **spiritual guidance or wise counsel** can be instrumental in identifying and managing one's ego.
14. The author shares a **personal struggle with ego**, stressing that awareness was the first step but change required effort, prayer, and support.
15. When dealing with egoistic individuals, the Gita recommends **leading by example rather than confrontation**, focusing on one's own spiritual growth.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



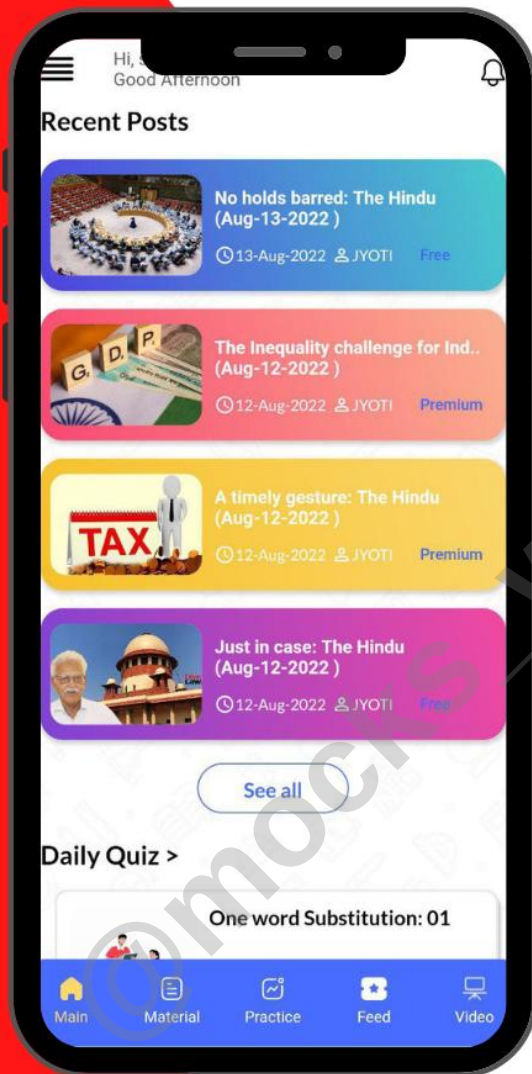
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